

Matt Eaton

Phone: (847) 902-9939
Email: mreaton@clermson.edu

Website: matthew-r-eaton.github.io/
LinkedIn: linkedin.com/in/matt-r-eaton

Education

Ph.D. in Economics <i>Clemson University</i> Primary Field: Labor, Secondary Field: Public	Exp. May 2027
M.S. in Applied Economics <i>Marquette University</i> Specialization: Business Analytics	May 2020
B.A. in Economics and Political Science <i>Marquette University</i> Concentration: Political Economy	May 2019

Research Interests

Labor Economics, Public Economics, Economics of Crime, Economics of Education

Job Market Paper

"The Effects of Focused Deterrence on Crime and Community Outcomes in Philadelphia" (with N. Dunagan, & B. Stalvey)

Focused Deterrence is a crime-reduction strategy that combines an increased probability and severity of punishment with direct communication of consequences to individuals identified as likely offenders. Philadelphia implemented Focused Deterrence in 2013 in response to rising gun violence. We estimate this policy's effects on crime rates as well as community downstream effects on rental pricing and housing valuations. Using a standard difference-in-difference design, we find that the number of shooting victims declined by 41.3 percent and gun crime incidents fell by 24.2 percent. Total reported crime incidents declined by roughly 13.8 percent, reflecting reductions in both violent and non-violent offenses. This reduction in crime resulted in increases in rental prices between 6.0 to 7.5 percent, and housing values from 3.6 to 7.0 percent. Together, these findings suggest that Focused Deterrence's crime-reduction effects extend beyond its direct targets, and that this broader improvement in neighborhood safety is capitalized into local housing and rental markets.

"Involuntary Part-Time Employment, Gig Rollout, and the Flexibility of Work"

(with S. Banerjee) (Under Submission)

We examine how the staggered rollout of UberX across 207 U.S. metropolitan areas affected involuntary part-time employment. Using a difference-in-differences design, we find that UberX entry reduces involuntary part-time employment by 10 percent as a share of the labor force and 8.7 percent as a share of total part-time employment, with little evidence of offsetting labor market flows. These results suggest gig platforms enable workers to shift from involuntary to voluntary part-time arrangements, offering a new margin of labor market flexibility.

"When the Mines Close: Coal Employment Shocks and Family Health Impacts in Appalachia" (with M. Bullard & M. Lambert)

We study how coal mining employment affects health outcomes across populations in Appalachian mining-dependent counties, using coal-to-natural-gas substitution in electricity generation as a shift-share instrument for county-level coal demand. Mining employment increases deaths of despair among working-age men, driven entirely by drug poisonings consistent with occupational opioid exposure, and worsens reproductive health, raising fetal deaths, low birth weights, and preterm births. Conversely, mining employment decline harms populations outside the workforce, lowering birth rates and raising poisoning-driven deaths of despair among children and the elderly. This poisoning pathway appears unique to Appalachia, not coal mining generally.

In Progress

"First-Generation and College Choice"

"Abortion Access and Institutional Demand for Higher Education: Evidence from Dobbs v. Jackson Women's Health Organization" (with B. Stalvey)

"Judicial Bias in Capital Sentencing in Early 20th Century South Carolina" (with N. Dunagan)

"The Effects of Focused Deterrence on Education Outcomes in Philadelphia" (with M. Laha)

Teaching Experience

Instructor, Clemson University

2024 to Present

- Principles of Microeconomics (7 sections)

Teaching Assistant, Clemson University

2022 to Present

- Intermediate Microeconomics (7 sections)

- Principles of Microeconomics (1 section)

- Sports Economics (1 section)

- Principles of Macroeconomics (1 section)

- Environmental Economics (3 sections)

- Government and Business (3 sections)

Teaching Assistant, Marquette University

2019 to 2020

- Principles of Microeconomics (2 sections)

Research Presentations

2026

- Southern Economic Association 96th Annual Meeting, Houston, TX (Scheduled)
- Clemson Labor Economics Workshop, Fall and Spring Clemson, SC (Scheduled)

2025

- Southern Economic Association 95th Annual Meeting, Tampa, FL
- Clemson Labor Economics Workshop, Fall and Spring, Clemson, SC
- Price Theory Summer Camp, University of Chicago - Becker Friedman Institute for Economics, Chicago, IL

2024

- Southern Economic Association 94th Annual Meeting, Washington, DC
- Clemson Labor Economics Workshop, Fall and Spring, Clemson, SC
- Clemson Applied Theory Reading Group, Spring, Clemson, SC

2023

- Clemson Labor Economics Workshop, Fall and Spring, Clemson, SC

Professional Experience

Instructor & Graduate Research/Teaching Assistant
Clemson University, John E. Walker Department of Economics
Clemson, SC

Aug. 2022 to Present

- Teach introductory economics courses, translating technical models and statistical reasoning into an accessible course for undergraduates with little to no quantitative background.
- Support faculty across coursework and research, assisting with grading and office hours in advanced economic courses and contributing to data construction for ongoing projects.

Economist

Nov. 2020 to July 2022

U.S. Department of Labor, Bureau of Labor Statistics, Office of Price and Living Conditions, Producer Price Index
Washington, D.C.

- Operated monthly data production, review, and validation for 15 industries within the Producer Price Index (including Petroleum Refineries and Petrochemicals Manufacturing), ensuring data collection and integrity for nationally published economic indicators.
- Presented analyses on notable price movements and their drivers to leadership, trade associations, data users, and researchers, highlighting data-driven methodologies and trends.

Associate Educational Research Scientist

Aug. 2020 to Nov. 2020

U.S. Department of Education, Institute of Educational Sciences, National Center for Education Statistics
Washington, D.C.

- Managed the IPEDS Graduation Rates and 200% Graduation Rates Survey, supporting a national data collection used for federal education policy and reporting.

Institutional Research Assistant

Aug. 2018 to June 2020

Marquette University, Office of Institutional Research and Analysis (OIRA)

Milwaukee, WI

- Managed Marquette University's First Destination Survey end-to-end—design, data collection, cleaning, and reporting of post-graduation outcomes—and built dashboards and executive summaries for leadership and other institutional data projects.

Awards & Honors

Department of Economics Graduate Assistantship 2022 to Current
Clemson University - John E. Walker Department of Economics

Dr. Myles Wallace Fellowship 2026 to Current
Clemson University - John E. Walker Department of Economics

Dr. Robert T. Tollison Fellowship 2025 to 2026
Clemson University - John E. Walker Department of Economics

Clemson University Graduate Student Government Travel Grant 2024, 2026
Clemson University - Graduate Student Government

Best 2nd-year Paper 2023-2024
Clemson University - John E. Walker Department of Economics

Marquette University Graduate Assistantship 2019 to 2020
Marquette University - Department of Economics

Marquette University Klinger Arts and Sciences Explorer Scholarship 2016 to 2019
Marquette University - College of Arts and Sciences

Marquette University Pere Marquette Scholarship 2016 to 2019
Marquette University

Skills

Programming & Statistical Software	R, STATA, SAS, Python, SQL
AI Tools	Claude/ChatGPT Agents
Research & Data Tools	Tableau, Qualtrics, ArcGIS, L ^A T _E X Bloomberg Terminal

References

Devon Gorry
Associate Professor of Economics
Clemson University
dgorry@clemson.edu

Robert Fleck
Professor of Economics
Clemson University
rfleck@clemson.edu

Jonathan Leganza
Assistant Professor of Economics
Clemson University
jleganz@clemson.edu